

AsciiDoc Advanced Syntax Cheatsheet ©

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[Quadhelion Engineering](#) - [QHE Articles](#) - [QHE Guides](#)



Quadhelion Engineering Advanced AsciiDoc Cheatsheet. Includes .adoc used to generate this page and PDF formatted version.

[adoc](#) - [PDF](#)

```
= AsciiDoc Advanced Syntax Cheatsheet (C)
Elias Griffin <elias@quadhelion.engineering>
v1.0.2, 2026-02-16
:homepage: https://www.quadhelion.engineering
:url-home: https://www.quadhelion.engineering/articles.html
:guides-home: https://www.quadhelion.engineering/guides.html
:license: Copyrighted, Elias Christopher Griffin, Quadhelion Engineering, 2024 ©
:toc: left
:sectanchors:
:sectlink:
:experimental:
:imagesdir: /home/wravoc/www/quadhelion.engineering.update/images
:sourcedir: /home/wravoc/www/quadhelion.engineering.update/guides
:source-highlighter: rouge
:icons: font
:link-docs: https://asciidoctor.org/docs[documentation]
:summary: Quadhelion Engineering Advanced AsciiDoc Cheatsheet. Includes .adoc used to
generate this page and PDF formatted version.
```



All header configs are optional and it may not contain any empty lines and must be separated from the content by at least one empty line.

Editors

- Pluma
- Geany
- Cosmic Editor
- [gedit](#)
- [Kate](#)
- [AstroNeovim](#)

Export

```
ruby --version
gem install asciidoctor asciidoctor-pdf rouge

// Export to HTML with same file name
asciidoctor AsciiDocCheatSheet.adoc

// Export to PDF
asciidoctor-pdf AsciiDocCheatSheet.adoc
```

Comments

```
// A single-line comment
```

```
////  
A multi-line comment.  
With two lines.  
////
```

Escaping

In `/items/{id}`, the `id` attribute isn't replaced.
`\*Stars*` isn't displayed as bold text.
`\§` appears as an entity reference.

Single and double plus inline passthroughs

A word or phrase between single pluses, such as `+user/{id}+`, is not substituted. However, the special characters like `<+>` and `<+>+` are still escaped in the output.

An attribute reference within a word, such as `dev++{conf}++`, is not replaced.

A plus passthrough will escape standalone formatting marks, like `+`'+`, or formatting marks within a word, like `all-natural++*++`.

Triple plus inline passthrough and inline pass macro

`+++<u>underline me</u>+++` is underlined.
`pass:[<u>underline me</u>]` is also underlined

Text

Page format

- Horizontal Rule `'''`

- Page Break `<<<`
- Line break `<space>+`

Definitions

First term:: The description can be placed on the same line as the term.

Second term::
Description of the second term.

The description can also start on its own line.

First term

The description can be placed on the same line as the term.

Second term

Description of the second term. The description can also start on its own line.

Table 1. Text styling

Style	Syntax	Style	Syntax
bold	<code>*bold*</code>	Single arrow	<code>-></code>
italic	<code>_slanted_</code>	Double arrow	<code>=></code>
bold+italic	<code>*_both_*</code>	Em dash	<code>--</code>
code	<code>`ls`</code>	super	<code>c^2^</code>
inline	<code>un_real_</code>	sub	<code>H~2~O</code>
highlight	<code>#in yellow#</code>	Copyright	<code>(C)</code>
underline	<code>[.underline]#this#</code>	Registered	<code>(R)</code>
strike	<code>[.line-through]#that#</code>	Trademark	<code>(TM)</code>



Any named, numeric or hexadecimal XML character reference is supported.

Lead paragraph

`[.lead]`

This text will be styled as a lead paragraph (i.e., larger font).

Links, mailto, IRC

```
link:index.html[Docs]
https://asciidoctor.org
https://asciidoctor.org[Asciidoctor]
devel@discuss.example.org
mailto:devel@discuss.example.org[Discuss]
irc://irc.freenode.org/#asciidoctor
https://chat.asciidoc.org[Discuss AsciiDoc,role=external,window=_blank]
https://chat.asciidoc.org[Discuss AsciiDoc^]
link:++https://example.org/?q=[a b]++[URL with special characters]
```

Context block

.Optional Title

Sidebars are used to visually separate auxiliary bits of content that supplement the main text.

Optional Title

Sidebars are used to visually separate auxiliary bits of content that supplement the main text.

Section titles

When the document type is article (the default), the document can only have one level 0 section title (=), levels cannot be skipped when nesting sections.

= Document Title (Level 0)

== Level 1 Section Title

=== Level 2 Section Title

==== Level 3 Section Title

===== Level 4 Section Title

===== Level 5 Section Title

== Another Level 1 Section Title

[discrete]

==== I'm an independent heading!

This paragraph is it's sibling, not it's child.

Anchors

Block Anchors

Make the reference

```
[#anchor1]
Anchor 1, a paragraph or a list, or a table.
```

Use the reference

```
<<anchor1>>
```

A link to <<anchor1>> in text.

- * List Item 1
- * List Item 2
- * <<anchor1>>

```
.Scores
[cols=" ",options="header",]
|===
| Factor          | Value
| Threats         | 9.8
| Vulnerability   | 7.75
| Impact          | 9.80
| Entrenched      | 22.67
| Integration     | 10.50
| Exploit Chain   | 18.27
| Anchor1         | <<anchor1>>
|===
```

Inline

```
[[bookmark-a]]Inline anchors#asciidoc
```

```
[#bookmark-b]#Inline anchors can be applied to a phrase like this one highlighted in yellow.#
```

```
anchor:bookmark-c[]Use a cross reference to link to this location.
```

```
[[bookmark-d,last paragraph]]The xreflabel attribute will be used as link text in the cross-reference link.
```

Use the inline anchor

Be sure to visit <<bookmark-a>>

Cross references

Section Titles like `<<Code>>` are automatically recognized

Cross reference in another document

Refer to `xref:AsciiDocCheatSheet2.adoc#Code`

Include other documents or documents from URLs

```
include::AsciiDocCheatSheet.md[]
include::AsciiDocCheatSheet.md[lines=5..10]
include::https://raw.githubusercontent.com/wravoc/authlog-
threats/main/docs/SECURITY.md[]
```



Content from a URL is potentially dangerous, so it's disabled if the safe mode is SECURE or greater. Assuming the safe mode is less than SECURE, you must also set the `allow-uri-read` attribute to permit the AsciiDoc processor to read content from a URL.

Assign ID (anchor) and role to inline formatted text

```
[#id-name.role-name]'monospace text'
[#free-world.goals]*free the world*
```

Functions



You must enable `:experimental:` in the header

Menu Simulation

To save the file, select `menu:File[Save]`.
Select `menu:View[Zoom > Reset]` to reset the zoom level to the default setting.

Button Simulation

Press the `btn:[OK]` button when you are finished.
Select a file in the file navigator and click `btn:[Open]`.

Images

```
image::sunset.jpg[]
image::sunset.jpg[Sunset, align="center"]
```

```
.A mountain sunset  
[#img-sunset,caption="Figure 1: ",link=https://www.flickr.com/photos/javh/5448336655]  
image::macros:sunset.jpg[Sunset,200,100]
```

```
image::https://asciidoctor.org/images/octocat.jpg[GitHub mascot]
```

Click image:play.png[] to get the party started.

Click image:pause.png[title=Pause] when you need a break.

```
image:sunset.jpg[Sunset,150,150,role=right] What a beautiful sunset!
```

Code

Indent one space to auto format for code

```
` or use backticks `
```

```
```\n\nor use triple backticks\nfor multiple lines\n```\n
```

## Output literal monospace text

Like `{backtick}` or `http://localhost:8080` by enclosing the text in a pair of pluses surrounded by backticks.

Like `++{backtick}++` or `++http://localhost:8080++` by enclosing the text in a pair of pluses surrounded by backticks.

## Code Block Examples

```
.Gemfile.lock

GEM
 remote: https://rubygems.org/
 specs:
 asciidoctor (2.0.15)

PLATFORMS
 ruby
```

#### DEPENDENCIES

asciidoctor (~> 2.0.15)

```

Some Ruby code
[source,ruby]

require 'sinatra'

get '/hi' do
 "Hello World!"
end

```

### Code with steps

```
[source,ruby]

require 'sinatra' <1>

get '/hi' do <2>
 "Hello World!" <3>
end

<1> Library import
<2> URL mapping
<3> HTTP response body
```

```
require 'sinatra' ①

get '/hi' do ②
 "Hello World!" ③
end
```

- ① Library import
- ② URL mapping
- ③ HTTP response body

### Code Included from a file

```
[source, lua]

include::/home/elias/qhedev/QCITE/qcite.lua[]

```

```
:sourcedir: /home/elias/qhedeu

[source, lua]

include::{sourcedir}/QCITE/qcite.lua[]

```

## Passthrough code block

```
++++
<p>
Content in a passthrough block is passed to the output unprocessed.
That means you can include raw HTML, like this embedded Gist:
</p>

<script src="https://gist.github.com/mojavelinux/5333524.js">
</script>
++++
```

## Lists

### Unordered List

```
* List item
** Nested list item
*** Deeper nested list item
* List item
 ** Another nested list item
* List item
```

An empty line is required before and after a list to separate it from other blocks. You can force two adjacent lists apart by adding an empty attribute list (i.e., []) above the second list or by inserting an empty line followed by a line comment after the first list. If you use a line comment, the convention is to use `//-` to provide a hint to other authors that it's serving as a list divider.

### Ordered list

```
. Level 1 list item
.. Level 2 list item
... Level 3 list item
.... Level 4 list item
..... Level 5 list item
. Level 1 list item
```

### Checklist

- \* [\*] checked
- \* [x] also checked
- \* [ ] not checked
- \* normal list item

## Question and answer list

[qanda]  
What is the answer?:  
This is the answer.  
  
Are cameras allowed?:  
Are backpacks allowed?:  
No.

1. *What is the answer?*  
This is the answer.
2. *Are cameras allowed?*  
*Are backpacks allowed?*  
No.

## Advanced Mixed List

Operating Systems::  
Linux::

- . Fedora
  - \* Desktop
- . Ubuntu
  - \* Desktop
  - \* Server

BSD::

- . FreeBSD
- . NetBSD

Cloud Providers::  
PaaS::

- . OpenShift
- . CloudBees

IaaS::

- . Amazon EC2
- . Rackspace



Lists can be indented. Leading whitespace is not significant. List continuation operator + (plus) sign

\* AsciiDoc lists may contain any complex content.

```
|===
|Column 1, Header Row |Column 2, Header Row

|Column 1, Row 1
|Column 2, Row 1
|===
```

## Audio Video

```
audio::ocean-waves.wav[]
audio::ocean-waves.wav[start=60,opts=autoplay]
video::video-file.mp4[]
video::video-file.mp4[width=640,start=60,opts=autoplay]
video::RvRhUHTV_8k[youtube]
video::67480300[vimeo]
```

## Labels

NOTE: An admonition draws the reader's attention to auxiliary information.  
IMPORTANT: Don't forget the children!  
TIP: Look for the warp zone under the bridge.  
CAUTION: Slippery when wet.  
WARNING: The software you're about to use is untested.  
IMPORTANT: Sign off before stepping away from your computer.

### Label block

```
[NOTE]
====
An admonition block may contain complex content.

.A list
- one
- two
- three

Another paragraph.
====
```

### Blockquotes

```
[quote,Abraham Lincoln,Address delivered at the dedication of the Cemetery at
Gettysburg]
```

```

Four score and seven years ago our fathers brought forth
on this continent a new nation...
```

```

[quote,Albert Einstein]
A person who never made a mistake never tried anything new.
```

```

A person who never made a mistake never tried anything new.
```

```

[quote,Charles Lutwidge Dodgson,'Mathematician and author, also known as
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lewis_Carroll[Lewis Carroll]']
```

```

If you don't know where you are going, any road will get you there.
```

```

"I hold it that a little rebellion now and then is a good thing,
and as necessary in the political world as storms in the physical."
-- Thomas Jefferson, Papers of Thomas Jefferson: Volume 11
```

## Tables

Simple Table, ignores spacing, very writeable, readable

```
.Scores
[cols="",options="header",]
|===
| Factor | Value

| Threats | 9.8
| Vulnerability | 7.75
| Impact | 9.80
| Entrenched | 22.67
| Integration | 10.50
| Exploit Chain | 18.27
| Potency | 27.11
|===
```

Table with a title, two columns, a header row, and two rows of content

```
.Table Title
|===
|Column 1, Header Row |Column 2, Header Row
```

```
|Cell in column 1, row 1
|Cell in column 2, row 1

|Cell in column 1, row 2
|Cell in column 2, row 2
|===
```



Unless the cols attribute is specified, the number of columns is equal to the number of cell separators on the first (non-empty) line. When an empty line immediately follows a non-empty line at the start of the table, the cells in the first line get promoted to the table header.

Table with two columns, a header row, and two rows of content

```
[%header,cols=2*]
|===
|Name of Column 1
|Name of Column 2

|Cell in column 1, row 1
|Cell in column 2, row 1

|Cell in column 1, row 2
|Cell in column 2, row 2
|===
```



The `*` in the cols attribute is the repeat operator. It means repeat the column specification across the remaining columns. In this case, we are repeating the default formatting across 2 columns. When the cells in the header are not defined on a single line, you must use the cols attribute to set the number of columns in the table and the %header option (or options=header attribute) to promote the first row to the table header.

Table with three columns, a header row, and two rows of content

```
.Applications
[cols="1,1,2"]
|===
|Name |Category |Description

|Firefox
|Browser
|Mozilla Firefox is an open source web browser.
It's designed for standards compliance,
performance, portability.
```

```
|Arquillian
|Testing
|An innovative and highly extensible testing platform.
Empowers developers to easily create real, automated tests.
|===
```

In this example, the cols attribute has two functions. It specifies that this table has three columns, and it sets their relative widths. View result of Example 70

#### Table with column containing AsciiDoc content

```
[cols="2,2,5a"]
|===
|Firefox
|Browser
|Mozilla Firefox is an open source web browser.
```

It's designed for:

- \* standards compliance
- \* performance
- \* portability

<https://getfirefox.com>[Get Firefox]!

```
|===
```

View result of Example 71

Example 72. Table from CSV data using shorthand

```
,===
```

Artist,Track,Genre

Baauer,Harlem Shake,Hip Hop

```
,===
```

#### Table from CSV data

```
[%header,format=csv]
|===
Artist,Track,Genre
Baauer,Harlem Shake,Hip Hop
The Lumineers,Ho Hey,Folk Rock
|===
```

#### Table from CSV data included from file

```
,===
```

```
`include::customers.csv[ ]`
,===
```

### Table with formatted, aligned and merged cells

```
[cols="e,m,^,>s",width="25%"]
|===
|1 >s|2 |3 |4
^|5 2.2+^.^|6 .3+<.>m|7
^|8
|9 2+>|10
|===
```

1	2	3	4
5	6		
8			
9	10		

### Shorthand method for assigning block ID (anchor) and role

```
[#goals.incremental]
* Goal 1
* Goal 2
```



To specify multiple roles using the shorthand syntax, delimit them by dots. The order of id and role values in the shorthand syntax does not matter.

### Shorthand method for assigning block options

```
// options can be shorted to opts
[opts="header,footer,autowidth"]
|===
|Header A |Header B
|Footer A |Footer B
|===
```

## Bibliography

\_The Pragmatic Programmer\_ <<pp>> should be required reading for all developers.  
To learn all about design patterns, refer to the book by the "'Gang of Four'" <<gof>>.

```
[bibliography]
== References
```

```
* [[[pp]]] Andy Hunt & Dave Thomas. The Pragmatic Programmer:
From Journeyman to Master. Addison-Wesley. 1999.
* [[[gof,gang]]] Erich Gamma, Richard Helm, Ralph Johnson & John Vlissides.
Design Patterns: Elements of Reusable Object-Oriented Software. Addison-Wesley. 1994.
```

## Footnotes

```
A statement.footnote:[Clarification about this statement.]
A bold statement!footnote:disclaimer[Opinions are my own.]
Another bold statement.footnote:disclaimer[]
```

```
A statement.[1]
A bold statement![2]
```

```
Another bold statement.[2]
1. Clarification about this statement.
2. Opinions are my own.
```

## Embedded Data

```
:data-uri:
image/gif;base64,R0lGODlhEAAQAMQAAORHHOVSKudfOulrSOp3W0yDZu6QdvCchPGolf00o/XBs/fNwfjZ0
frl3/zy7////ViFDlTImbKC5Gm2hB0SlBCBMQiB0UjIQa7
```



When the data-uri attribute is set, all images in the document—including admonition icons—are embedded into the document as data URIs. You can also pass it as a command line argument using `-a data-uri`.

## Counters

```
.Parts{counter2:index:0}
|===
|Part Id |Description

|PX-{counter:index}
|Description of PX-{index}

|PX-{counter:index}
|Description of PX-{index}
|===
```